

HEALTH INEQUALITY

- Health inequality is a major issue for most countries
- The difference in **life-expectancy** is one outcome...(case of Calton and Lenzie in Glasgow)
- The difference in **socio-economic** conditions also causes health difference (poverty can be associated sometimes but not always)...

Measuring health inequality

- The standard measure is **Gini coefficient**,
- It operates between two points: 0 (absolute equality) and 1 (only a few possess majority of resources)
- Sometimes described in percentage (0.45 becomes 45%)



Relationship between health and inequality

- Only one third of the reasons are due to traditional risk factors and rest two-third is influenced by social processes (ex. smoking)
- Analysis of **psycho-social factors**
- Stress – what we have inherited from past – evolved to **experience status and hierarchy** – negative impact on health
- Study draws from non-human primate studies
- Stress in human (**corticoids becoming maladaptive**)

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- Highly unequal societies generate harmful **social interaction**
 - One most evident is **Insecure ego...** self-promoting
 - **Narcissistic epidemic in** American culture
 - Downside— reality doesn't match self-perception (poor mental and physical health for self and others too)
 - Increased **privatization of public space...**(secure yet isolated) fear of imagined others
 - Inequality also results **disrespect for others**
 - Study highlighted effects of ***disempowerment*** on health (social hierarchy and disempowerment)
 - Disempowerment can be conceptualized in three forms
 - ***Material disempowerment:***
 - ***Psycho-social disempowerment:***
 - ***Political disempowerment:***

GENDER AND HEALTH

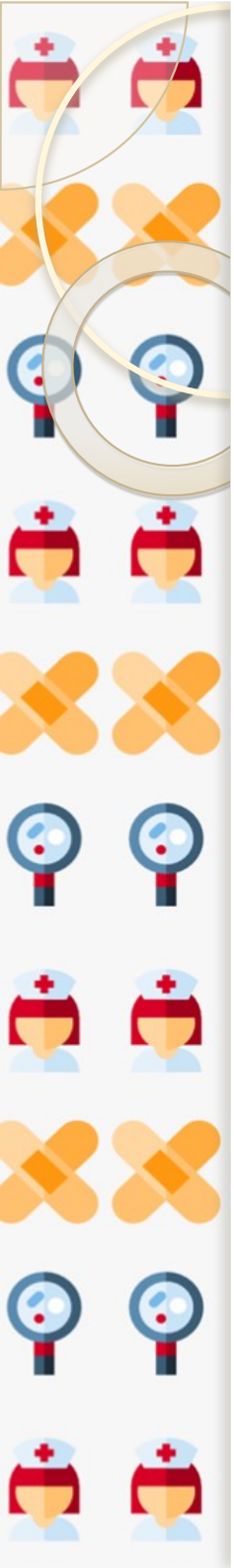
- What is gender!
- What it means to be a man or woman (depends on where we live and the historical aspects)
- Case of UK and USA (before and after war)...the nature of work and of working women...physical or technical works...
- Change in the traditional gender role



- Traditional sign of **femininity** + sign of **masculinity**
- From **passive** home maker to **active** factory worker
- The '**image**' was later used by feminist movements
- **Color pink** is another example of fluidity of gender (in Victorian Britain...pink as juvenile tone of red)

Gender and health

- Particular gendered practices (doing gender) hegemonic masculinity...
- Russian men and their gender roles ...

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- Gender also affects **communication health needs**
 - Case of fire fighters and their healthcare needs
 - Depression among men in Canada...clear rational of steps, similar to other aspects of masculinity
 - Use of biomass fuel by women causing COPD
 - **Gender and power** influencing health (case of HIV among women in southern Malawi)
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MIGRATION AND HEALTH

- Globalization resulting in migration (sometimes beyond control circumstances)
- There can be six identifiable trends of migration
 - The **globalization** of migration
 - The **changing direction** of dominant flows of migration
 - The **differentiation** of migration
 - The **proliferation** of migration transition
 - The **feminization** of migrant labour
 - The growing **politicization** of migration

ETHNICITY AND HEALTH

- Reference is not biological or genetic traits, rather social
- A common cultural heritage that is socially learned and constructed
- Case of Sickle Cell Disease (SCD)...**Ethnoization** of disease
- Ethnicity is misused as a sociological concept and categorizes people
- Relationship between ethnicity and ***risk factor/profile***

RACISM AND HEALTH

□ Racism consists of three dimensions

- **Prejudice**
- **Discrimination**
- **Institutional racism**
- Racism realized in ***lived experience***...fear of racism, the worry and stress

□ Other ways (beyond direct health concerns)!

□ Mental health concerns compared to physical health

SOCIAL CLASS AND HEALTH

- Strong link between social class and health...sociologists label social class a “*fundamental cause*” of disease

Link between poverty and illness:

- Illness causing poverty
- Poverty causing illness—
 - Experience **more stress** and have **less control** over that stress
- Stress amplifies health risks of poor in many ways:
 - Work available
 - Environmental conditions and climate change also affects the poor
 - Inadequate, overcrowded, and unsafe housing
 - The food poor children eat—or don’t eat
 - **Cumulative inequality theory...**